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# The Tale of The Illusionist Princess

by Xanakis (IceRosesCrown)

## Summary

While certainly uncommon from her sometimes and only sometimes, Shadow Weaver tells her wards a bedtime story. These are, of course, horror stories.
Tonight, she shall tell the story of the Illusionist Princess of the floating Labyrinth Island...

Aka
A "Goblin King"-inspired story with Castaspella as an evil princess :3

## Notes

Oh yay, we're posting this!

Many thanks to Bereaved Buckle for organizing this event :D
Lovely idea <3

Make sure to check out the whole series until Halloween!

And now, without further ado, please enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

This is the story of the Illusionist Princess;of the floating Labyrinth Island, the regent.

Within its spell-bound walls, acolytes lie in wait;sad pitiful creatures of blind faith.

They follow their wicked Princess'every command, to take poor innocent Etherians to their *doom in their land*…

Only the horde's strongest dare go near, yet even their fates lie unclear.

One day came a superior squad and tore into the Labyrinth ready for a fight, yet almost all were exterminated before anyone could even hear of their plight.

The same men who ran to take on any kind of battle, could only scream as they were slaughtered like cattle.

Their leader, dashing and commanding, was now left the last man standing.

Shaking eyes came which could no longer see clear, widened as they watched the Illusionist Princess appear…

Spells infected their mind!Reality began to slip away. Leaving a torn brain, one that couldn't tell apart night from day.

The Princess and her spells overwhelmed them with ease, soon she had brought them to their knees…

The true size of her power could never be put into scale, as no one who could bare witness to it lived to tell the tale…

Some say she is taller than any training bot. But others, that it's only a spell to look down on the fresh meat she's so frequently brought.

Some insist she has piercing eyes, and that sharp teeth in her mouth glean, while others claim only pitch-black holes in her face can be seen…

And those fortunate enough to have escaped from her claws' hold, will swear that her touch is ice-cold.

Count your days, Princess! a child's voice interrupted. We will become the best squad of the Horde! We'll enter the Labyrinth and slay you!

Will you, Adora? Shadow Weaver asked, seemingly amused.

For that, she should first *exist*. Lonnie scoffed, hugging her pillow.

While little Adora inked having a blaster, standing on her bunkbed, Catra remained at her feet, snickering.

She's right. You're so silly, Adora. the magicat chuckled.

I I am. Are you sure she's not real? Kyle asked, latching onto Rogelio, despite being just as small as him. I wouldn't want to…

She's not real, Kyle!

And who told you so, Cadet? Shadow Weaver inquired, raising a brow at Lonnie.

She's real?! Kyle gasped, going pale.

If she's real, then how did she take control of the Labyrinth? Catra defiantly asked.

Because now, you must know how Princesses work. the dark sorceress began. All Princesses are driven and by their power. It was no different with this one.

The legends speak of an old ruler of yore, who presided over the Labyrinth long ago.

She wanted to take his crown, her mind ran with plans to bring him down.

The Illusionist Princess cornered him, drained all of his power; now on his grave lies nothing but a wilted flower.

And with him out of the way, the Illusionist Princess took the floating Labyrinth Island by force, covering every corner with her spells and images. She truly showed no remorse…

The faithful acolytes pleaded their loyalty and removed the dissidents from all around. Then her spells covered the walls, and turned the Labyrinth into her playground.

~~And~~ that's why we fight to free Etheria from Princesses! ~~A~~dora proudly announced, earning a groan from Catra and Lonnie.

~~Can~~t you scare her already? ~~the~~ magicat asked Shadow Weaver, earning a glare.

~~Y~~eah, but.speak normally. That sounds silly, not scary ~~L~~onnie added, greatly offending the dark sorceress.

~~Ad~~ora.~~sh~~e called, making the girl look up at her. ~~D~~o you agree? Does it sound… *silly*?

~~a~~ bit? ~~S~~he admitted, sitting sheepishly.

~~Al~~right then, I shall narrate what happened to the ~~H~~orde Squad ~~norm~~ally." ~~S~~hadow W eaver sighed, rolling her eyes and wondering why she was even doing this.

The sky was dark and stormy around the floating Labyrinth. Rain and hail made the arrival difficult, but the squad made it to the entrance all the same.

Leaving the darkness and uncertainty behind, the Force Captain guided everyone inside with three clear orders: do not get separated, do not heed any unknown voices, and do not trust your eyes.

With firm steps, the leader took charge walking through the labyrinth, searching for the center where they hoped to find the Princess they must slay.

Everything looked the same, however; cold and rusty walls disguised as precious, colorful murals surrounded them, the arched passageways and frames through which they stepped led to colder halls, and wide windows appeared at each side, through which illusory gardens could be seen…

The horde soldiers had the feeling they were not going anywhere, that they remained on the outer rings of the labyrinth, yet their leader knew better. They could see through the deceiving spells. And the Illusionist Princess would have none of that.

Right after stepping through another arched frame, the weakest soldier heard giggles.

As he gasped, the Force Captain halted and paid better attention to the sounds around them. Tiny steps, a rustle here and there, more giggles…

Reminding them the three orders, the leader pressed on, refusing to let those creatures ruin their mission. The acolytes of the Princess would *not* stop them now, when it was clear they were on the right path.

Yet more giggles could be heard with every step they took, and the weakest soldier shook with fear. He couldn't go on, his legs refused to move, and the more he separated from the group, the more open he was left to the likes of the acolytes.

A loud scream suddenly startled the squad, and the next thing they saw, was that scrawny blond soldier being dragged away into the darkness…

Interrupted by laughter from Lonnie and Catra, Shadow Weaver gave the kids a minute.

Gripping a pillow tightly against his chest, Kyle stammered ~~Th~~That was- That-that sounded like me~~.~~ That wont happen to me, ri-right?

~~D~~Dont be a baby~~.~~ Lonnie chuckled. ~~O~~Of course it would~~.~~ if that was real~~.~~ she mocked him.

~~O~~Oh, but it is *very* real~~.~~ Shadow Weaver interceded.

~~M~~Mhm, sure~~.~~ Catra hummed, rolling her eyes before seeing Adora curled up, looking at the dark sorceress. ~~A~~Are you scared?

~~N~~No! I just want to know how it continues…

~~I~~If your *friends* stop interrupting me, then I shall~~.~~ Shadow Weaver promised Adora, making her give Catra a pleading look.

~~F~~Fine… *Silly*.

The Force Captain picked up his lost soldier's blaster and ordered everyone to continue, reminding them *not to get separated*.

This is what happens when you ignore orders in enemy territory.

As they moved forward, deeper into the Labyrinth, the giggles no longer followed. However, the leader could guess what the next threat would be…

Once they entered the following hallway, the magicat of the group caught sight of something outside.

Through the windows, which the Force Captain had already mentioned were nothing but illusions, the soldier swore she saw something moving quickly.

*Very* quickly.

Something small, like a critter, with a tail…

The soldier attempted to ignore it, but her fur kept puffing with every sight of the small shadow.

And as they pressed on, closer and closer to the center of the Labyrinth, the magicat began noticing *more* of those things passing outside. Then *inside*…

Panicking, the soldier backtracked, not even making a sound, and finally ran away into the darkness, never to be seen again…

Followed by the illusion of a thousand more only she could see.

~~Ah!~~ Catra squealed, hairs puffed as she jumped back to hide behind Adora.

~~Maybe she~~ *should* have made a sound. ~~–~~Shadow Weaver mockingly said.

While Lonnie and Rogelio laughed at Catra's reaction to the shadow mouse the dark sorceress had conjured up, Adora tried to calm Catra down.

~~Y~~ou did that on purpose! ~~t~~The magicat complained.

~~Wh~~o's the baby now? ~~–~~Lonnie taunted her, making Catra growl until Adora stopped her.

~~Co~~mon, now, allow me to finish the story. ~~–~~Shadow Weaver decided.

With only two of their people left, the Force Captain's determination hardened.

They *would* reach the center and they *would* slay that wretched princess…

However, it wasn't long before the lizardfolk of the squad fell under one of her illusions.

Forgetting the strict orders he had been given, he trusted his eyes when the soldier next to him suddenly turned into a menacing creature.

And before the Force Captain could so much as turn around, the sound of his blaster forced them to take cover!

The lizardfolk aimed at them now, didn't obey their orders to lower the blaster; his mind was gone, his deafening roars echoed through the hall. So the leader was forced to shoot before he could.

With the bodies of their last remaining soldiers at their feet, they let rage take over them and ran deeper into the labyrinth, now a squad-less Captain.

~~Did~~ you just give Rogelio and me the latest deaths?! Connie immediately complained.

~~You~~ both look very alive to me. Shadow Weaver condescendingly replied, joining the tips of her fingers. Unless you'd want me to change that.

~~Nope!~~ The girl denied, while Rogelio roared in fear.

~~Then~~ I advice you to keep *quiet*.

The leader of the squad had lost everyone. Only their own life remained, and they would make sure to use it wisely.

Determined to reach the center of the Labyrinth, the Force Captain ran through corridors refusing to stop, ignoring illusions and whispers, shooting at anything that moved…

Only when they reached a large chamber, wide enough that the edges couldn't be seen through the light fog, did they stop to catch their breath, yet remaining alert.

Through their messy blond hair, they kept watch on their seemingly empty surroundings. Their hands on their blaster, ready to shoot at a moment's notice…

The Force Captain couldn't be sure whether they had reached the center, but they could feel the danger around them more so than anywhere else in the Labyrinth.

Hence, they closed their eyes, focused on their hearing, and slowly advanced deeper into the chamber.

They raised their blaster and aimed at the sound of a low laughter, immediately halting. They were sure that had to be the Princess, moving around them like a predator…

Following the sound with the blaster, waiting to shoot, the Force Captain turned around slowly, and suddenly rolled to the side dodging a spell, before standing on their knees and shooting back.

A screech confirmed that they hit the target, but they knew that only meant they had angered the Princess.

Wanting to reverse their roles, turning into the predator, the leader without a squad rushed forward. They would avenge their soldiers.

Shooting repeatedly, the blaster started to heat up, but they didn't stop until the magical shield broke and immediately lunged at her, knocking the Princess into the ground.

However, the laughter that came from under them was different.

They hadn't tackled the Princess but an acolyte posing as her.

Before they could react, the Force Captain was hit with a spell that threw them to the right until they hit a wall. Blood pooled inside their mouth, which they had to spit on the ground before attempting to stand up again.

They had let the illusions of that wretched Princess confuse them.

It couldn't happen again.

Closing their eyes again, feeling the imminent danger, they sidestepped to the left, barely dodging a blast that cracked the wall.

They had to run; they couldn't remain standing there, an easy target for the Princess.

As they ran and dodged more attacks, the Force Captain's mind began searching for a way to counterattack... until they bumped against a cold surface, not a wall but a *mirror*; hence, a plan formed in their mind.

With the last few shots they had, the Princess' attention was drawn right into their trap, and when she launched her attack, it only shattered the mirror, giving her no time to dodge a hit from behind.

This time, the Force Captain had pinned down the actual Princess.

But now, how would they slay her?

Out of energy in the blaster, and with no backup weapons, only their hands could finish the job.

Yet the Princess laughed in their face, even with the hands pressing her neck…

The Force Captain soon understood. This wasn't over.

And that, cadets, is how the story ends.

A collective groan rose from the kids, whose voices overlapped with complains.

Then Adora's question came through amidst the noise.

Did the Force Captain win? she asked, eyes shining.

What do you think, Adora? Shadow Weaver asked back.

I don't know. I hope they did, she admitted, looking down.

Only because it's obvious the Force Captain represented you— Lonnie said, rolling her eyes.

Hey! she complained, yet got cut short by Shadow Weaver.

I'm sure you can slay that Princess one day, Adora. As long as you don't neglect your training, of course, she told her. Aim for excellence and no Princess will ever defeat you.

With a scoff, Catra folded her arms and said Come on, this was just a story, that Princess doesn't exist.

I'll keep training! I'll slay her! Adora obediently nodded, looking at Shadow Weaver with determination, and making the magicat sigh in defeat.

Caressing her blonde hair in a way that made Catra recoil slightly, the dark sorceress confirmed I know you will.

## End Notes

That was it for my story ^_

I hope you guys enjoyed and that you'll return for the rest of the stories :D

See ya somewhere else, and happy halloween!
Thank you for reading :)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!